

Thailand



The Kingdom of Thailand is the only country in Southeast Asia never colonized by Europeans.

1350 The Thai kingdom of Ayutthaya succeeds the state of Sukhotai.

1569 The Burmese defeat Ayutthayan forces and rule the kingdom for 15 years.

1767 The Burmese occupy the Thai capital of Ayutthaya once again, this time bringing an end to Ayutthayan rule.

1782 Rama I founds the Chakri dynasty that still rules the country, and makes Bangkok the capital of Siam.

1826 Rama III concludes a treaty establishing trade with the West but maintaining independence.

1851 King Mongkut succeeds his elder brother Rama III to the throne.

1855 Mongkut signs the Bowring trade treaty with the UK, which ensures that Siam retains its independence.

1868–1910 King Chulalongkorn embarks on a program of Westernization.

1907 Siam cedes western Khmer (Cambodia) and southern Laos to France.

1925 King Prajadhipok begins a period of absolute rule.

1932 In a bloodless coup, the power of the monarchy is curtailed and a parliament is created, elected by universal suffrage.

1939 Siam is renamed Thailand.

1941 Japan invades and the government is effectively controlled by the Japanese.

1944 Pro-Japanese prime minister Phibun is voted out of office.

1945 Exiled King Ananda returns.

1946 Ananda is assassinated. King Bhumibol accedes to the throne.

1947 A military coup restores former dictator Phibun to power.

1951–57 The US pours aid into Thailand, seen by the US as a key ally in the Cold War.

1957 The constitution is abolished in another military coup.

1965 Thailand allows the US to use Thai bases during the Vietnam War.

1968 New constitution endorses an elected parliament.

1971 Army suspends constitution.

1973–76 Student riots lead to a restoration of democracy.

1976 Renewed military takeover.

1980–88 General Prem Tinsulanonda is prime minister.

1988 General Chatichai Choonhaven, the right-wing leader of the Thai Nation Party (CT), is named prime minister.

1991 Military coup installs civilian Anand Panyarachun as caretaker premier.

1992 General Suchinda is named premier. Following demonstrations, the king forces him to step down and reinstalls Anand.

1995 The CT wins the general election.

1996 Early elections; Chaovalit Yongchaiyuth of the New Aim Party becomes prime minister.

1997 Amid a financial and economic crisis, the Chaovalit government falls. The Democratic Party's Chuan Leekpai becomes prime minister.

2001 Thai Rak Thai (TRT), led by Thaksin Shinawatra, wins elections.

2004 Five thousand killed by a tsunami on December 26.

2006 Thaksin Shinawatra is overthrown by the military and sent into exile.

2007 Rak Thai party banned. A new pro-Shinawatra party, the People's Power Party, wins most votes in general election.

2008 Facing trial for corruption, Shinawatra flees to Britain. People's Alliance for Democracy (PAD) protesters occupy government buildings in Bangkok and block flights from Bangkok airport. Opposition leader Abhisit Vejjajiva becomes prime minister.

2010 Pro-Thaksin Shinawatra Red Shirt protesters in Bangkok are defeated.

«172–73 Lost Empires



Peaceful coup d'état

Tanks roll into Bangkok on September 19, 2006. The army suspended the constitution and declared martial law, but pledged to restore democracy. Many supported the coup.

Laos



Since 1975 Laos has been a communist state but market-oriented reforms are under way.

1893 A Franco-Siamese treaty establishes French control over all territory east of the Mekong River.

1899 Creation of Laos under the French.

1941 Japanese seize power from the Vichy French in Indochina.

1946 French rule resumed.

1950 Lao Patriotic Front (LPF) set up to oppose French rule. It gains the support of the newly formed communist Lao People's Party (LPP).

1954 Laos gains independence as a constitutional monarchy backed by France and the US.

1963 LPF begins an armed struggle against royal government through its armed wing, the Pathet Lao.

1964 US bombs North Vietnamese sanctuaries in Laos.

1973 The Laos People's Revolutionary Party (LPRP, formerly the LPF) and royal government form a coalition after the withdrawal of US forces from Indochina.

1975 LPRP seizes power, abolishes the monarchy, and proclaims the Lao People's Democratic Republic. Premier Kaysone Phomvihane adopts policies for a "socialist transformation" of the economy.

1977 A treaty providing for mutual security is signed with Vietnam.

1978 Popular unrest and resistance to collectivization. The former king and crown prince are arrested and die in captivity. Almost 50,000 Laotians flee to neighboring Thailand.

1986 Fourth Party Congress introduces market-oriented economic reforms.

1989 National elections are held. All candidates approved by LPRP.

1990 Counter-offensives are carried out against right-wing, largely Hmong guerrilla bases in the outer provinces.

1997 Laos accedes to ASEAN.

1999 Popular protests demand greater political freedom.

2004 Laos hosts the annual ASEAN summit for the first time.

2006 Over 400 ethnic Hmong, hiding in the jungle since the end of the Vietnam War, surrender to the authorities.

«350–51 Colonial Resistance
«412–13 End of the Colonial Era

Cambodia



An ancient kingdom, Cambodia is slowly recovering from decades of violent civil conflict.

802 CE Jayavarman II founds Khmer Empire, which becomes centered on the temple and city complex of Angkor Wat.

1431 Siamese kingdom of Ayutthaya captures Ankor Wat and royal court moves to Phnom Penh.

1863 Cambodia becomes French protectorate headed by King Norodom; becomes part of French Indochina in 1887.

1953 Cambodia becomes independent.

1954 At Geneva peace conference, French and Vietnamese nationalists agree to withdraw forces from Cambodia.

1955 King Sihanouk abdicates to pursue a political career, taking the title Prince.

1970 Right-wing coup led by prime minister Lon Nol deposes Sihanouk. Exiled Sihanouk forms Royal Government of National Union of Cambodia (GRUNC), backed by communist Khmer Rouge.

1975 GRUNC troops capture Phnom Penh. Khmer Rouge assumes power with Prince Sihanouk as head of state. Huge numbers die under extremist regime.

1976 Country renamed Democratic Kampuchea. Sihanouk resigns. Pol Pot becomes prime minister.

1978 Vietnam invades, supported by communists opposed to Pol Pot.

1979 Vietnamese capture Phnom Penh. Khmer Rouge ousted by Kampuchean People's Revolutionary Party (KPRP). Khmer Rouge starts guerrilla war.

1982 Government-in-exile, headed by Prince Sihanouk, is recognized by UN.

1989 Withdrawal of Vietnamese troops.

1990 UN-monitored ceasefire.

1991 Signing of Paris peace accords. Sihanouk reinstated as head of state.

1993 Elections won by royalist Funcinpec. Sihanouk takes the title King.

1997 Coup by prime minister Hun Sen.

1998 Pol Pot dies; Khmer Rouge disarms.

1999 Cambodia admitted to ASEAN.

2001 Law approved on trials of Khmer Rouge leaders for atrocities.

2004 Sihanouk abdicates and is replaced as head of state by his son Sihamoni.

2007 Nuon Chea, the most senior surviving Khmer Rouge leader, is arrested.